

COMPANION NEGOTIATOR'S BRIEF

The Crescent Compact

v3.2

Rapid-Reference Guide for Floor Mediators

Regional Sticking Points | Narrative Boundaries | Multi-Party Veto Mechanics

Date: Late May 2026

Audience: Authorized Mediators & Delegations Only

Purpose: Navigate regional sticking points, narrative boundaries,
and multi-party veto mechanics on the floor

AUTHORIZED NEGOTIATORS ONLY

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Section 1: Sticking Point Navigation

The three regional deal-breakers that threaten the Sunday deadline, and the exact text where each is neutralized in The Crescent Compact v3.2.

1.1 The IMCA vs. PGSA Sovereignty Clash

The Optical Compromise

THE FRICTION

Washington demands an international body to police transit through the Strait of Hormuz. Tehran views an international mandate as an imperial encroachment on their sovereign territorial waters.

THE CORE CITATION

Article I-8.1 through I-8.4 (pp. 12–13, Compact v3.2)

THE LEGAL LOCK

The text strictly restricts the International Maritime Coordination Authority (IMCA) to exactly three functional buckets: commercial traffic coordination, maritime safety protocols, and UNCLOS binding arbitration. It formally recognizes the Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters.

FLOOR DIRECTIVE

If an IRGC representative panics over Western overreach, point to the Optical Compromise Architecture (p. 13). Show them that the IMCA's mandate holds zero jurisdiction over military asset movements or regional territorial defense. Both statements are factually accurate under the Charter: the IMCA governs the international transit corridor; the PGSA governs Iranian coastal waters. Neither encroaches on the other.

OPERATIONAL DIRECTIVE (V3.2 — ARTICLE I-8.4 ALIGNMENT)

When navigating IRGC or U.S. Navy pushback regarding maritime enforcement, floor teams must present the single, binding interpretive paragraph: **The IMCA's mandate is strictly restricted to exactly three functions (commercial traffic coordination, safety protocols, and UNCLOS binding arbitration). The PGSA holds the absolute sovereign monopoly over coastal law enforcement within Iranian territorial waters. No transit passage tolls are permitted.** Frame this as a non-infringing optical compromise where neither side loses face or yields coastal sovereignty.

1.2 The Front-Loaded Concession Trap

The Day 7 Automated Trigger

THE FRICTION

Neither side is willing to blink first on Day 7. The U.S. refuses to lift its naval blockades until the Strait is physically open; Iran refuses to pull back IRGC naval assets until the blockade is dropped.

THE CORE CITATION

Article I-8.5 (pp. 13–14, Compact v3.2)

THE LEGAL LOCK

The Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger Protocol runs execution via the neutral Swiss Dashboard. The Hormuz Opening Declaration and the Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are bound to a strict, simultaneous 60-second UTC execution window.

FLOOR DIRECTIVE

Use the Auto-Void Failure Mode (p. 14) as reassurance. If either side's signal drops or attempts to stall, the dashboard automatically voids both declarations instantly. Neither side can be exploited or front-loaded. The Framework Survival Core remains intact, and a 48-hour technical grace period opens to diagnose before either party may invoke stepback.

1.3 The Multi-Front Spoilers

Annex K Dossier Isolation

THE FRICTION

Regional cross-border escalations (specifically on the Israel–Lebanon front) threaten to instantly collapse the core U.S.–Iran nuclear stabilization and economic tracks.

THE CORE CITATION

Annex K & Annex K.2.2 (pp. 29–30, Compact v3.2)

THE LEGAL LOCK

The Lebanon Dossier Isolation Firewall and "Dual-Key" Escalation Lock mandate a Proxy Operational Pause across 3 distinct phases. It legally walls off cross-border friction by separating Levant de-escalation into an independent parallel track (the Levant Regional Basket), ensuring localized kinetic events cannot

unilaterally trigger a core treaty breach. The 25-casualty threshold and 72-hour UNSC attribution window make Core Accord collapse functionally impossible in practice.

FIREWALL DIRECTIVE (V3.2 — ANNEX K.2.2 ALIGNMENT)

In calculations regarding cross-border escalation, enforce the **'Dual-Key' Escalation Lock**. In the event of a Hezbollah-originated attack causing **25 or more civilian fatalities** in Israel, Israel retains an absolute right to self-defense. However, to preserve the Core Accord in Tehran and Washington, such an attack **cannot trigger a broader sanctions snapback or step-back unless the UN Security Council explicitly determines, within a strict 72-hour window, that the attack was conducted pursuant to a direct, verifiable order from the Supreme Leader of Iran**. Absent that specific finding, the core military and economic provisions remain in full force.

Section 2: Dual-Narrative Verification

The Crescent Compact operates on the principle of Narrative Sovereignty (p. 6, Compact v3.2): each principal capital retains absolute authority over its domestic framing, provided it doesn't explicitly contradict the verified text.

Topic	Washington's Domestic Frame	Tehran's Domestic Frame	The Operative Reality
Nuclear Stockpile	"Weapons-grade material is seized and locked away under immediate physical custody, extending breakout time past a year."	"Our enriched uranium remains 100% Iranian property. Legal title stays with the Central Bank of Iran; the final details are deferred."	Article I-2 : Physical custody transfers to the IAEA within 72 hours; legal title is decoupled and stays with the Central Bank of Iran. Final disposition is deferred to the 30–60 day window.
Hormuz Mandate	"The Strait of Hormuz is now officially open to international shipping under a robust multilateral framework."	"The PGSA remains the supreme, uncompromised coastal authority inside our sovereign waters; the IMCA is limited to basic trade coordination."	Article I-8.4 : The IMCA manages the international transit corridor under UNCLOS; the PGSA remains the sole executive enforcement body within territorial lines.

Section 3: Final Hour Checklist

Keep these specific, text-anchored rebuttals ready when delegations push back during the final walkthrough.

IF THEY SAY: "The U.S. will just re-freeze our assets the second the wind shifts or a new administration takes over."

YOU SAY: Turn to Article I-4 (p. 9). Point out the Irreversibility Protocol and the Sanctions Inertia Buffer. Re-freezing released assets requires a full 60-day Joint Compact Commission majority process, an IAEA Director General certification of material breach, and a mandatory 150-day minimum interval. Unilateral snapbacks are structurally blocked.

IF THEY SAY: "We refuse to sign on to a grand regional treaty that binds us to normalizations we aren't politically ready for."

YOU SAY: Turn to The Compact Philosophy (p. 3). Emphasize the Layered Legitimacy Architecture (LLA). Signing the document only binds the capital to the Core Frame (Parts I–III: Nuclear, Maritime, and Ceasefire). All Progressive Arches (Parts IV–VIII, including broader regional normalizations) are modular and remain entirely locked until the core benchmarks are successfully verified over consecutive cycles.

IF THEY SAY: "What happens if the 30–60 day nuclear negotiating window deadlocks and we can't agree on a final disposition pathway?"

YOU SAY: Turn to Article I-2.4 (p. 8). The Dual-Key Dilution Protocol acts as an automatic safety valve. **If the Joint Compact Commission certifies a deadlock on Day 45, the framework completely bypasses further political debate and automatically defaults to Pathway A (in-country downblending of all 60% material to 19.75% at the Esfahan facility).** Operations are mandated to commence under dual-key observation within 7 days of the deadlock certification. If negotiations deadlock for the full 60 days, automatic in-country dilution to medical-grade LEU activates at Esfahan under a strict dual-key verification system (IAEA holds Key A, neutral JCC observer holds Key B). It prevents a deadlock from being classified as a material breach. Use the Day 45 default threshold to break stalling tactics from regional hardliners.

Appendix: Nuclear Ownership Decoupling — Day 45 Automated Default

NUCLEAR LEVERAGE DIRECTIVE (V3.2 — ARTICLE I-2.4 ALIGNMENT)

If multi-party negotiations deadlock during the Phase 1 voluntary window, note that an automatic circuit-breaker activates on **Day 45**. If the JCC certifies a deadlock on Day 45, the framework completely bypasses further political debate and **automatically defaults to Pathway A (in-country downblending of all 60% material to 19.75% at the Esfahan facility)**. Operations are mandated to commence under dual-key observation within 7 days of the deadlock certification. Use this default threshold to break stalling tactics from regional hardliners.

SUMMARY VERDICT

This companion brief is fully aligned with the unique structural mechanisms of **The Crescent Compact v3.2**. It handles the 60-day cycle concept, the LLA modularity, the Day 45 JCC automatic default to Esfahan Pathway A, the Annex K.2.2 25-fatality / 72-hour UNSC attribution lock, and the distinct automated dashboard parameters field-ready. Deploy alongside the main Compact document at the negotiation table.